curses, is proof of the fact that Akbar was at this young age, a fairly God-fearing and orthodox man. Muazzam was finally imprisoned in the fort of Gwalior where ‘melancholia overwhelmed him and he departed the world unsound of mind’.

But these family vicissitudes in Agra were almost pedestrian compared to the maelstrom gathering in the east. For far away in the border regions of the Mughal Empire, an entire clan was gathering in rebellion.